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Julien Crésus-Ashton

SENIOR INTERACTION DESIGNER

Senior interaction designer with eight years in UK government and consumer apps. I design accessible services, test them with users and prototype in code.

EXPERIENCE

Cognizant
Nov 2023 – Present

Senior Interaction Designer

- Designing and prototyping a case-management service for ICS (Integrated Corporate Services), now in beta. Interaction design and coded "GOV.UK Prototype Kit" prototypes, using AI services to speed up coding and iteration.
- Led interaction design for the Welsh Council Tax service at HMRC (HM Revenue and Customs) during alpha, in Welsh and English, for all 22 Welsh local authorities. Assisted multiple research rounds.
- Designed journeys for Natural England's protected sites monitoring service, from workshop sketches to Figma screens and a coded prototype, tested with ecologists and field surveyors.
- Designed a workforce planning tool for DEFRA (Department for Environment, Food and Rural Affairs) and APHA (Animal and Plant Health Agency) on PowerBI, replacing team spreadsheets with one view of activities and absences for managers, within the constraints of Microsoft's design system.
- Set the standard for personas, interaction models and WCAG (Web Content Accessibility Guidelines) 2.2 across the team.
- Coached and led other designers on GDS (Government Digital Service) and coded prototyping.

DAM Digital
Apr 2022 – Nov 2023

Senior UX Designer

- Led UX on Shy Lifestyle (a luxury concierge app, live at shylifestyle.com), Rethink Mental Illness's donation module and McArthurGlen's shopping app, across up to 3 concurrent clients.
- Ran regular design reviews with clients and turned stakeholder feedback into design decisions grounded in user needs.
- Owned accessibility and design system standards across all concurrent projects, keeping them consistent.
- Coached a user researcher to produce production-ready Figma prototypes.

Methods
Feb 2019 – Apr 2022

UX Designer

- Designed for government programmes including Every Mind Matters, National Funding Formula and Ministry of Defence, working to GDS standards across discovery, alpha and beta.
- Led cross-functional workshops with research, product and engineering, setting the design direction and ensuring decisions were grounded in user evidence before moving to build.
- Built research-informed prototypes in Figma and coded prototypes in React and the GOV.UK Design System.

Société Générale Design
Sep 2017 – Dec 2018

UX/UI Designer Trainee

- Designed interaction models for trading platforms and internal financial tools in low- and high-fidelity using Adobe XD and Sketch, shipping interface updates to internal trading systems used daily by the trading floor.
- Led co-creation sessions with traders, product owners and engineers to validate concepts early.

SKILLS

- GDS Design System
- WCAG 2.2 accessibility
- Coded prototyping (React, GOV.UK Prototype Kit)
- Conditional routing and policy logic
- Service and journey mapping
- Workshop and design critique facilitation
- AI tools (Claude, Copilot)
- Figma, Sketch, Miro, Mural

EDUCATION

MSc UX Design (Merit)
Kingston University, London
2016 – 2017 · Thesis: WebVR app for autism awareness, exploring immersive environments as a medium for inclusive design and empathy-building.

BA Web Design
Epitech Digital, Paris
2016

LANGUAGES

French (Native)

English (Fluent)

German (Basic)